

BEFORE THE STATE BOARD OF LICENSED PROFESSIONAL COUNSELOR EXAMINERS

STATE OF COLORADO

Case Nos. 2016-5408 and 2017-4846

ORDER OF SUMMARY SUSPENSION

TO: STEPHANIE RINK

The State Board of Licensed Professional Counselor Examiners ("Board"), having reviewed all available information as to the matters referenced below, **HEREBY FINDS AS FOLLOWS:**

1. Stephanie Rink ("Respondent") has been licensed as a Licensed Professional Counselor in the State of Colorado since May 10, 2007. Respondent's credential number is LPC 4648.
2. The Board has jurisdiction over Respondent and the subject matter herein
3. In October 2016, the Board received a complaint ("Case No 2016-5408") alleging unprofessional conduct, lack of self-regulation, poor communication, and boundary violations on the part of the Respondent.
4. In July 2017, the Board received a second complaint ("Case No. 2017-4846") alleging substandard practice, boundary violations, breach of confidentiality and improper recordkeeping on the part of the Respondent.
5. In January 2018, Respondent underwent a mental status evaluation ("MSE") with Peer Assistance Services, Inc. ("PAS") per Board Order. The MSE indicated Respondent was not safe to practice as a LPC with reasonable skill and safety without treatment and monitoring.
6. Upon a full investigation of the documents and information presented in regard to Case Nos. 2016-5408 and 2017-4846, the Board finds as follows:
 - a. Respondent failed to notify the Board of a physical illness; a physical condition; or a behavioral, mental health, or substance use disorder that affects her ability to treat clients with reasonable skill and safety or that may endanger the health or safety of persons under her care in violation of § 12-43-222(1)(f)(I), C.R.S.;

- b. Respondent acted or failed to act in a manner that does not meet the generally accepted standards of practice of professional counseling in violation of § 12-43-222(1)(g)(l), C.R.S.;
- c. Respondent maintained relationships with clients that are likely to impair her professional judgement and/or increase the risk of client exploitation in violation of § 12-43-222(1)(i), C.R.S.; and,
- d. Respondent falsified or repeatedly made incorrect essential entries and or failed to make essential entries on patient records in violation of § 12-43-222(1)(u), C.R.S.

7. Upon full investigation of the documents and information presented, the Board finds objective and reasonable grounds to believe and finds that Respondent is not safe to practice as an LPC with reasonable skill and safety to patients and the public health, safety, and welfare imperatively requires emergency action. As a result, Respondent's license to practice professional counseling in the State of Colorado must be summarily suspended.

8. The Board hereby summarily suspends Respondent's certification to practice as an LPC pursuant to §§ 12-43-224(2)(c)(ll)(A) and 24-4-104(4)(a), C.R.S.

9. Respondent cannot engage in the practice of professional counseling in the State of Colorado or hold herself out as able to practice professional counseling in the State of Colorado while her license is suspended.

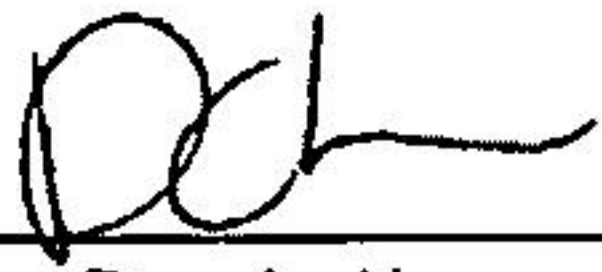
10. Any violation of this Order constitutes a violation of a lawful Board Order and may be grounds for further proceedings pursuant to § 12-43-224, C.R.S. The pendency of any disciplinary action shall not affect the obligation of Respondent to comply with this Order.

11. This Order does not resolve any other cases, complaints, or matters, known or unknown to the Board or Respondent, as of the effective date of this Order.

12. This Order shall be a public record in the custody of the Board.
THEREFORE, pursuant to the above, IT IS HEREBY ORDERED that under §§ 12-43-224(2)(c)(ll)(A), 24-4-104(4) and 24-4-105(12), C.R.S., the certification of Stephanie Rink to practice professional counseling in the State of Colorado is summarily suspended.

DATED this 5th day of March, 2018.

THE STATE BOARD OF LICENSED PROFESSIONAL COUNSELOR EXAMINERS

BY: 

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